

Thursday, 25 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 31° 22°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 35° 21°	MANCHESTER Partly cloudy 33° 22°	GLASGOW Overcast 28° 17°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The UK is facing hotter summers, with some regions potentially reaching 40 degrees Celsius regularly within a couple of decades.

A new report highlights a concerning trend in rising summer temperatures across the country. The question is, how prepared are we for these extreme weather conditions? It raises important discussions about infrastructure and public safety.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

A preliminary report suggests a train passed a red signal before a fatal crash, according to the Independent Rail Accident Investigation Branch.

This initial finding from the investigation into the tragic incident will be a key focus. Rail safety is paramount, and the report will shed light on the circumstances leading to the accident. It's a serious development in the ongoing inquiry.

TRANSPORT · UK
- 3

Police took eight minutes to discover a fatal stab wound on Southampton student Henry Nowak, who later died while handcuffed.

This tragic case raises serious questions about the actions of officers and the care provided. An investigation will undoubtedly look into the timeline of events and the procedures followed. It's a deeply concerning incident for all involved.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Six individuals have been jailed for life for the 'senseless' murder of Joanne Penney, a crime orchestrated from a prison cell.

This shocking case highlights a disturbing level of planning and coordination behind bars. The judge described the murder as 'senseless', bringing some closure to a horrific event. It's a stark reminder of the challenges in preventing such crimes.

CRIME · UK
- 5

The national grooming gang inquiry has announced its initial focus will be on Oldham, Bradford and Keighley, and London.

This crucial inquiry aims to uncover the extent of grooming gang activity and support victims. By focusing on these specific areas first, it hopes to gather vital evidence and provide justice. It's a significant step in addressing a deeply troubling issue.

What's coming up

1 **The TV Festival is set to move from Edinburgh to Manchester next year in a bid to 'radically' cut costs.**

This is a big change for one of the industry's most important events. It'll be interesting to see how the move impacts the festival's atmosphere and attendance. Manchester is certainly a vibrant city for it.

ON AIR – Is Manchester a good move for the TV Festival, or will it lose some of its Edinburgh charm?

TV · NEXT YEAR

2 **Bradford Culture Company has announced eight projects will receive funding as part of the City of Culture legacy grants.**

This is fantastic news for the arts and culture scene in Bradford. The grants will support a diverse range of initiatives, ensuring a lasting positive impact from its City of Culture status. It's all about investing in the local community.

ON AIR – What kind of cultural projects would you love to see funded in your local area?

CULTURE · ONGOING

3 **The YouTube sensation 'The Amazing Digital Circus' is hitting cinemas after fans campaigned for it to be shown.**

This is a great example of fan power making a real difference! It shows how popular online content can successfully cross over to the big screen. It's a huge moment for the creators and their dedicated audience.

ON AIR – What other YouTube hits do you think deserve a big-screen release?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **New PlayStation announcements include a talking cube, a female God of War, and a Wolverine game.**

Gaming fans have a lot to look forward to with these exciting reveals. The new God of War instalment, featuring Kratos' wife Laufey, is generating a lot of buzz. It promises some fresh takes on popular franchises.

ON AIR – Which of these new game announcements are you most excited about, or do you have another favourite?

GAMING · COMING UP

5 **Model and actress Cara Delevingne says her new music was inspired by getting sober, as she releases her first two songs.**

Cara is making a move into the music world, sharing a very personal journey through her new tracks. It's always inspiring to hear artists channel their experiences into their work. We wish her all the best with this new venture.

ON AIR – What do you think of celebrities branching out into new creative fields like music?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

On the schedule

1 Scotland are 'primed for the game of their lives' against Brazil in the World Cup, as they aim for the knockout stage.

The stakes couldn't be higher for the Scottish team in this crucial match. They'll need to improve on their previous performances to secure a spot in the next round. It's going to be a nail-biting encounter.

ON AIR – How confident are you that Scotland can pull off a result against Brazil and progress in the World Cup?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 England will assess the fitness of Reece James and Declan Rice ahead of their final World Cup group game against Panama.

Having key players fit is vital for England as they look to secure their position in the tournament. Their availability could significantly impact the team's strategy for this important match. Fingers crossed for good news on their fitness.

ON AIR – How crucial are James and Rice to England's chances in the World Cup, and who would step up if they can't play?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 Great Britain's Dan Evans is out of Wimbledon qualifying, bringing his singles career to an end.

It's the end of an era for Dan Evans in singles tennis, as he bows out of Wimbledon qualifying. He lost to Tristan Schoolkate in the second round, marking a significant moment in his career. We wish him all the best for the future.

ON AIR – What are your favourite memories of watching Dan Evans play over the years?
TENNIS · UK

4 England were held to a goalless draw by Ghana in their World Cup group stage match.

It wasn't the dominant performance many expected after their strong start to the tournament. Ghana put up a resolute defence, making it a challenging match for England. It's a result that will spark plenty of discussion.

ON AIR – What's your take on England's goalless draw against Ghana – a blip, or something more to worry about?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 Today is EFL fixture release day, with all the Championship, League One, and League Two fixtures being announced.

It's a big day for football fans across the country as they discover their team's schedule for the upcoming season. Supporters will be eagerly planning their matchday trips and looking for those key derby dates. The excitement for the new season truly begins now.

ON AIR – Which fixture are you most looking forward to seeing announced for your team today?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The great British picnic is being upgraded, with sales of fold-out chairs and cool bags climbing.**
We're venturing out more, weather permitting. The traditional picnic still ends, as ever, with at least one item dropped in the grass.
- 2 Allotment waiting lists have hit record highs across the UK.**
Councils in some areas now quote waits of several years. The most-grown first crop for beginners? Courgettes — closely followed by regret, as they produce far too many.
- 3 A survey finds most of us have at least one app we've never opened since downloading it.**
The average phone reportedly carries dozens of unused apps. Top of the 'meant to use it' pile: language-learning and meditation.
- 4 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 5 Slow cookers are flying off the shelves again as energy-conscious shoppers rediscover them.**
They use a fraction of the power of an oven over a day. The downside: the smell of dinner from 9am tests everyone's patience.
- 6 Tinned fish is unexpectedly trendy again, with younger shoppers leading the charge.**
Sardines and mackerel are being repackaged as a quick, cheap protein. Older shoppers are quietly baffled, having eaten it for decades.
- 7 Knitting and crochet are booming with a new generation, sold as the ultimate screen-free wind-down.**
Beginners start with scarves and quietly accumulate wool. The first project, makers admit, is usually 'a bit wonky but loved'.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 61% of us have lied about THIS to get out of a social event. What?

ANSWER: HAVING A COLD.

Q 53% of people admit to doing THIS in a restaurant when no-one's looking. What?

ANSWER: LICKING THE PLATE.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims our taste in music is 'locked in' by age 14.**

Talk-back: do you still listen to what you loved at 14? And what was on your bedroom wall?

- **What's the most embarrassing thing in your kitchen that you'd hide if guests came round?**

Talk-back: bonus marks for anyone admitting to a Slap Chop or a NutriBullet bought once and never used.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Records.** The shortest commercial flight in the world runs between two Scottish islands, Westray and Papa Westray, and can take under two minutes with a good tailwind.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A seaside town has installed Britain's first 'reverse' pier — a walkway that goes inland from the beach, after planners admitted they'd read the blueprints upside down.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£52 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£52 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A blue whale's tongue alone weighs as much as an elephant.
- Octopuses can taste with their suckers.
- Wales has more castles per square mile than any other country in the world.
- Bananas grow upside down.
- Your nose can detect over a trillion different scents.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way.
- A snail can sleep for three years at a time.

On this day

Day 176 of the year, 189 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Philippines); Christian feast day: David of Munktorp; Christian feast day: Dorothea of Montau; Christian feast day: Eurosia. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2002 — Benson Boone, American singer-songwriter
- 1947 — Jimmie Walker, American actor
- 1964 — John McCrea, American singer-songwriter and musician
- 1940 — Mary Beth Peil, American actress and singer
- 1925 — June Lockhart, American actress (died 2025)
- 1937 — Eddie Floyd, American R&B/soul singer-songwriter
- 1979 — Richard Hughes, Scottish footballer
- 2006 — Mckenna Grace, American actress, singer and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1950 — The Korean War begins with the invasion of South Korea by North Korea.
- 1975 — Mozambique achieves independence from Portugal.
- 1997 — An uncrewed Progress spacecraft collides with the Russian space station Mir.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1996 — American rapper Jay-Z releases his debut album, Reasonable Doubt.
- 2022 — Two people are killed and 21 more injured after a gunman opens fire at three sites in Oslo in a suspected Islamist anti-LGBTQ+ attack.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — PMTair Flight 241 crashes in the Dâmrei Mountains in Kampot Province, Cambodia, killing all 22 people on board.
- 1944 — The final page of the comic Krazy Kat is published, exactly two months after its author George Herriman died.

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1943 — The Holocaust and World War II: Jews in the Częstochowa Ghetto in Poland stage an uprising against the Nazis.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 177 of the year, 188 days left in 2026. Today Day of the Armed Forces of Azerbaijan; Christian feast day: Anthelm of Belley; Christian feast day: David the Dendrite; Christian feast day: Blessed Giacinto Longhin. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1983 — Nick Compton, South African-English cricketer
- 1984 — Aubrey Plaza, American actress
- 1922 — Eleanor Parker, American actress (died 2013)
- 1957 — Al Hunter Ashton, English actor and screenwriter (died 2007)
- 1943 — Georgie Fame, English singer, pianist, and keyboard player
- 1955 — Gedde Watanabe, American actor
- 1952 — Gordon McQueen, Scottish footballer and manager (died 2023)
- 1988 — King Bach, Canadian-American actor, comedian, director, producer, writer and social media personality

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — Air Canada Flight 189, flying to Toronto, overruns the runway and crashes into the Etobicoke Creek ravine. Two of the 107 passengers on board perish.
- 1991 — Yugoslav Wars: The Yugoslav People's Army begins the Ten-Day War in Slovenia.
- 2000 — The Human Genome Project announces the completion of a "rough draft" sequence.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules that the Communications Decency Act violates the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.
- 2007 — Pope Benedict XVI reinstates the traditional laws of papal election in which a successful candidate must receive two-thirds of the votes.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)